ONE-PAGE PREACHING OUTLINE

The One-Verse Deliverer

Shamgar · Judges 3:31

Primary text: Judges 3:31 **Also read:** Judges 5:6–8 · 1 Samuel 13:19–22 · Hebrews 11:32 · Philippians 2:5–11 **Big idea:** The size of your mention is not the size of your work: God saved Israel through a farmer with an oxgoad, and Jesus is the greater Deliverer whose name is above every name. **Time:** 55–60 minutes, including a 3–5 minute response (6,722 words at about 120 wpm). **Aim:** From measuring our lives by mentions to trusting the God who counts what the record skips; from waiting for a sword to using the goad in our hand.

MOVEMENT MAP

MIN	SECTION	BEATS AND TRANSITION
5	**Introduction: The shortest story**	Shamgar gets one sentence: name, father, enemy, number, tool, verdict. No birth, call, speech, or tomb. The world measures by mentions; God measures by deliverance. Big idea. → *"Let us read the one verse."*
7	**The roads went quiet**	Deborah's song: highways abandoned, travelers on byways, villages ceased, no shield or spear among forty thousand. Philistine iron and the disarmed hill country (1 Sam 13:19–20). New gods chosen; war in the gates. Yet the LORD raises up judges (Judg 2:16). → *"Into this world came a farmer with a stick."*
7	**The man from the edge**	Shamgar son of Anath: uncertain name, possible Canaanite resonance, Beth-Anath, Ben-Anath. God keeps choosing the wrong people: Ehud, Deborah, Gideon, Jephthah, Samson. "After him" — no call scene, no Spirit formula, no speech. The deed, not the biography. The chain of deliverance. → *"What was in his hand?"*
8	**The tool in his hand**	*Malmad habbaqar*: an eight-foot hardwood pole, iron point and chisel, used daily to drive and clean the plow. A pike with a work history. No sword because Israel was disarmed. God uses staffs, slings, jars, loaves, towels. The goad as an instrument of training (Acts 26:14) and a picture of the Word (Heb 4:12). → *"The tool is not the hero."*
8	**Six hundred and one**	Six hundred Philistines: a column, not a duel. The text gives a summary, not tactics; a campaign is possible. Philistine setting: Medinet Habu, Ashdod, Tel Qasile, Egyptian goads. "He also saved Israel" — *yasha*, the verb of Joshua/Jesus. The verse never names God; the book does. The verdict stands. → *"The one-verse deliverer points forward."*
8	**The Name above every name**	*Yasha* → Yeshua → Jesus (Matt 1:21). Shamgar kills the enemy; Jesus dies for the enemy. Peter's sword refused (Matt 26:52); the spear, the nails, the cross (Isa 53:5; John 19:34). "He saved others; he cannot save himself" (Matt 27:42) — the taunt is the truth. Resurrection. Philippians 2:9–11. Hebrews 11:32 omits Shamgar; the list is selective, heaven's ledger is not. → *"Come to the greater Deliverer."*
6	**Application: What do you do with one verse?**	Work the field you were given. Use the tool in your hand. Refuse the comparison of mentions. Trust the God who counts what the record skips. → *"The field is the platform."*
3	**The invitation**	Three people: the invisible, the one waiting for a weapon, the one fighting the wrong war. Come to the One with nails in His hands. → *"His name is Jesus. He saves."*
5	**Response and closing**	Silence. Three questions: the field, the tool, the sword you are waiting for. One hidden act of faithfulness this week. Care note for victims of violence (Rom 12:19). Prayer. One sentence. One Savior. → *"Go and work the field He has given you."*

Total: 57 minutes; 55–60 with normal variation.

LINES TO LAND

- "The size of your mention is not the size of your work."
- "Was shield or spear to be seen among forty thousand in Israel?"
- "He also saved Israel."
- "Shamgar picked up the goad. Jesus took the nails."
- "One sentence. One Savior. The record is short; the salvation is full."

GUARDRAILS

- Do not pad the story. The brevity is the point; do not invent a backstory or battle scene.
- Do not glamorize violence or model private revenge. He is God's instrument against an oppressor (Rom 12:19).
- Say plainly that Hebrews 11:32 does not list Shamgar. The omission is about the list, not his salvation.
- The gospel must be explicit: the cross, the resurrection, and the name above every name. Do not end on "be faithful" without the Savior.

IF YOU MUST CUT

- **To 50 minutes:** Introduction 4, Movement 1 6, Movement 2 6, Movement 3 7, Movement 4 7, Movement 5 7, Application 5. Keep Judges 5:6–8, the goad, "he also saved Israel," Matthew 27:42, and Philippians 2:9–11.